

time and energy on the things I want to do; my financial concerns are secondary. FI is about being able to incorporate meaningful work into my life rather than trying to squeeze in life around my job.

Jonathan described FI as having the freedom to fail. He said FI is defined by “the fact that you no longer have to work for money. In many cases, you find that you have the option to make more money because you’re able to take risks that you wouldn’t have considered in a more conservative nine-to-five, addicted to W-2 income era of your life.” He added, “Work doesn’t have to be related to earning. Freedom to fail allows you to pursue something that you love.” This circles back to the entrepreneurial spirit that leads many to invest in their own business at different stages on their path to FI, without the risk and associated fears that trap many on the standard path.

Brad thinks FI is about even more than the freedom to fail: FI gives you the freedom to explore. Once you have the financial part down, you can take a step back and look at your life holistically. This is where life gets interesting because you can start asking bigger questions. What do I get value out of? What do I enjoy? What would make me happier? How can I progress to bring me value in the future?